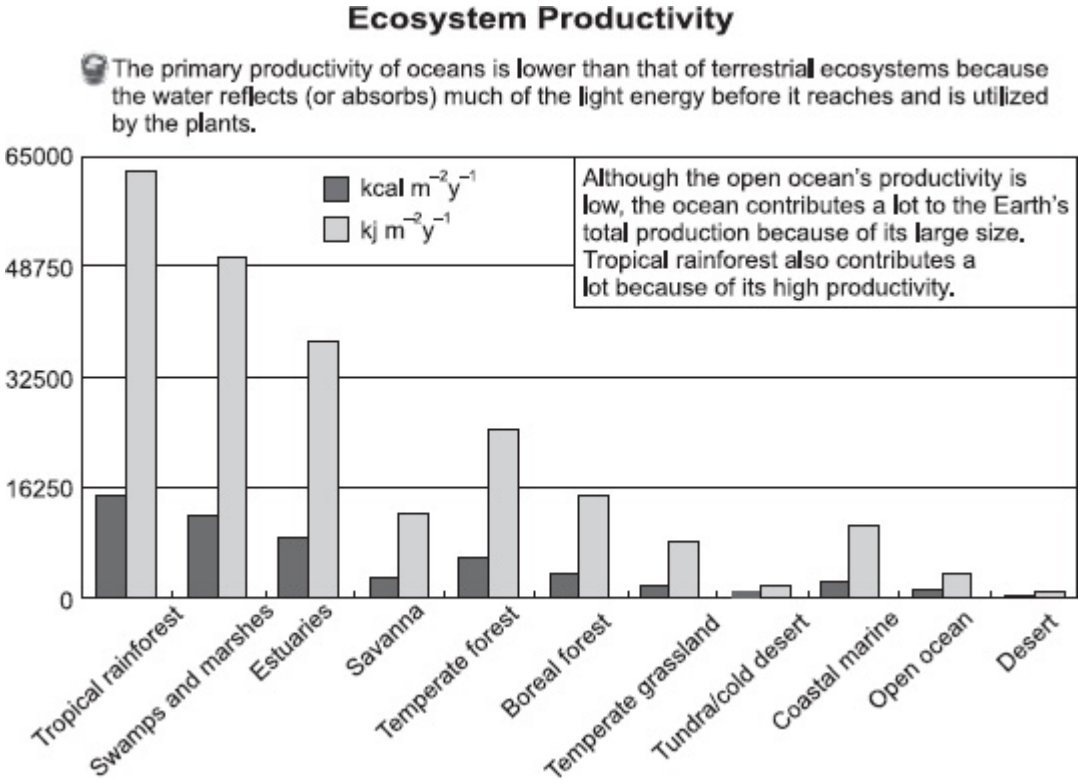
- Periphyton: These are organisms which remain attached to stems and leaves of rooted plants or substances emerging above the bottom mud such as sessile algae.
- Plankton: Microscopic floating organisms such as algae, diatoms, protozoans and larval forms are called plankton. This group includes both microscopic plants like algae (phytoplankton) and animals like crustaceans and protozoans (zooplankton).
- Nekton: This group contains powerful swimmers that can overcome the water currents.
- Benthos: The benthic organisms are those found living at the bottom of the water mass.




16.

- Productivity = production/unit area/unit time.
- Production/unit area depends on the number and diversity of producers.
- Ecotones have greater productivity compared to the surrounding ecosystems. Mangroves and grasslands are ecotones. (Tropical